



Maslan During Operation Roaring Lion: Continuity of Care in a Time of Crisis

Responding Under Fire

When Operation Roaring Lion began, Maslan faced an immediate and difficult reality. In compliance with Home Front Command directives, Maslan's physical center was temporarily closed on March 1, 2026. As the building lacks a protected shelter, closure was mandatory; a significant challenge for an organization whose work depends on trust, presence, and human connection. Despite this, Maslan's team acted swiftly and with determination to ensure that all beneficiaries had continued access to the care they needed, safely and without disruption.

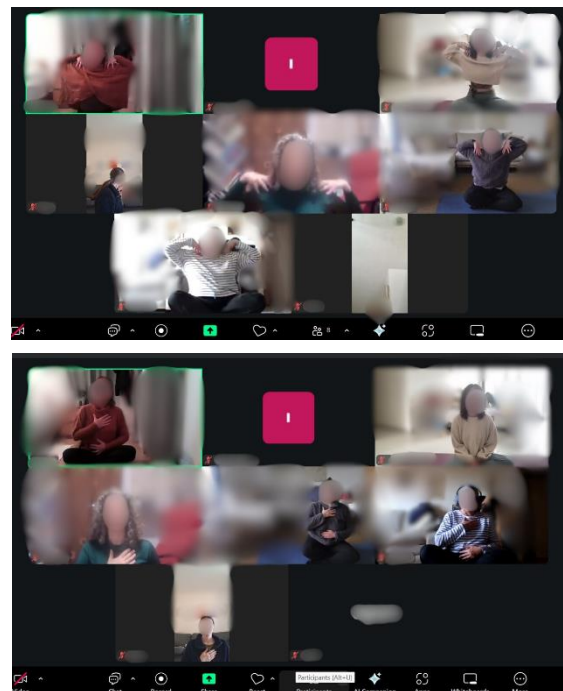
Continuity of Care: Activities During the Operation

24/7 Multilingual Helpline (1202)

Throughout the entire operation, Maslan's helpline remained fully operational without interruption. Call volume increased dramatically during this period: during the equivalent timeframe in 2025, the helpline received 61 calls. Since the outbreak of Operation Roaring Lion, that number rose to 179 calls, an increase of approximately 193%. This surge reflects the heightened distress experienced by survivors of sexual assault and domestic violence during periods of active conflict and underscores the critical importance of maintaining around-the-clock access to support.

Virtual Therapy Sessions

At the outset of the operation, Maslan's assistance coordinators and therapists convened to develop a continuity-of-care plan. With the security situation offering no clear end date, the team established both virtual therapy groups and individual therapy sessions. Approximately **30 women participated in 10 hours of virtual support groups** across 3 different groups, including the "Salon" support group, yoga therapy and a domestic violence support group for Russian speakers. Additionally, **11 different women received 36 hours of individual therapy**. Individual crisis support sessions and intake interviews were provided to beneficiaries who reached out in acute distress, requiring immediate stabilization and care. Additional individual check-ins were conducted with beneficiaries who had become unreachable during the operation, to verify their safety and assess their needs.



Material Assistance

In recognition of the compounded pressures of the Passover holiday season during an ongoing conflict, **40 women received food vouchers** to help alleviate financial strain during this exceptionally difficult period.

Impact on Beneficiaries





The psychological toll of the conflict on Maslan's beneficiaries was significant. Many experienced intensified trauma responses triggered by the ongoing security situation. In one particularly acute case, a missile strike in Beer Sheva directly affected one of Maslan's beneficiaries. Although she was physically unharmed, the incident left her severely disoriented and traumatized. Maslan's team responded immediately, ensuring she received the care and support required.

These cases reflect a broader pattern: for survivors of sexual violence, domestic abuse, and trauma, periods of armed conflict do not pause the need for care; they intensify it.

Support group participants reported that despite the difficulty of the period, group sessions supported their emotional regulation and provided a meaningful sense of relief and connection during a time of profound uncertainty. Some participants noted that they wished they had received more support during this time. The Assistance team is actively evaluating its support services to identify further improvements for future emergencies.

A Message from Mika Shaked: A Participant in Maslan's "Salon" Support Group

"This period of war, which arrived with such shocking suddenness, brought with it a flood of overwhelming feelings: anxiety, instability, uncertainty, the loss of any semblance of routine, difficulty sleeping, difficulty eating, and the disruption of even the most basic rhythms of daily life: sleep, food, safety, and more.

Alongside all of these struggles, some support did come from those around us, though for most of us survivors, it wasn't quite enough, or it didn't fully reach us in the way we needed. But there is one thing, above all else, that has given us so much: our connection to Maslan and our online support group sessions."



[To read her full message in English](#)

Reopening

On **April 9, 2026**, Maslan reopened its physical center, with support groups resuming that same day. In the weeks ahead, the team is working to restore full programming and provide therapy sessions and intake appointments to all who are waiting, including the many women who contacted Maslan during the operation but preferred to begin their process in person rather than virtually. Since the ceasefire and reopening, the Assistance team has reported that they are receiving a continued rise in incoming calls to the helpline. They are currently in contact with each of these individuals to begin their individual care plan. The need for support is real, immediate and growing.

